SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

AN ASSESSMENT OF COMPLIANCE TO THE REVISED MARKET CODE OF THE MUNICIPALITY OF NASIPIT

A Thesis Presented To
The Faculty of
College of Business and Management

In Partial Requirements for the Degree
BACHELOR OF PUBLIC ADMINISTRATION

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College Of Business Management And Accountancy

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ABSTRACT

TITLE: An Assessment Of Compliance To The Revised Market Code Of The Municipality Of Nasipit

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IV. RECOMMENDATIONS

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Objectives

- **Write a short introduction of your paper. Provide the direction of the study and nuances.**

Methodology

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Findings

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Write it in paragraph form narrative. See sample IN YOUR DISCUSSION

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Structure of a Dedication

1. **Opening Statement**
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2. **List and Explanation**
   - Example: *"To my parents, for their love and support, and to my advisor, Dr. [Name], for invaluable guidance."*
3. **Closing (Optional)**
   - Example: *"This work would not have been possible without you."*

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ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

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Suggested Structure

Opening Statement
• Express general gratitude for the opportunity to complete the research or thesis.

Acknowledgment of Advisors and Professors
• Thank your thesis advisor, committee members, or professors for their guidance and expertise.

Acknowledgment of Family and Friends
• Thank those who provided emotional or financial support.

Acknowledgment of Institutional or Financial Support
• Recognize scholarships, grants, or organizations that funded or facilitated your research.

Special Thanks (Optional)
Mention individuals who provided significant help, such as peers, mentors, or technical staff.

Closing Statement
• Conclude with a general expression of gratitude.

Example

I am deeply grateful to everyone who contributed to the completion of this thesis. My sincerest thanks to my advisor, Dr. [Name], for your invaluable insights and guidance. To my committee members, thank you for your constructive feedback and support.

To my family, your love and encouragement kept me going through this journey, and to my friends, your support meant the world to me. I would also like to thank [Institution/Organization] for funding this research.

Special thanks to [Name], for your assistance in [specific task]. To everyone who helped in any way, thank you for making this possible.

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Include all tables in your paper. Make sure that the tables are properly accounted for.

CHAPTER 1

THE PROBLEM AND ITS SCOPEssss

1.1 Background of the study

A public market is a vital component of local business and community life. People can exchange commodities, services, and cultural connections there. As a vibrant hub for people to congregate and a significant influence on nearby companies, it forms an integral part of many people's daily lives (Almonte et al., 2024). According to Zhong et al (2020), it is also crucial for local economic growth as it facilitates the establishment of small enterprises. According to Bonete et al. (2024), the public Market facilitates fair trade and food distribution in an environment that fosters community and a sense of belonging. The Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations (2024) asserts that local and traditional food shops are crucial in supporting small-scale farmers and ensuring access to healthy and fresh meals for individuals. It also mentioned that it is particularly true in nations where earnings fall below the middle class. They are essential links between sellers and buyers, and their presence enables small businesses to enter these markets more easily. A functioning market also has the potential to generate additional revenue for local governments (Wibisono et al., 2023).

International studies, on the other hand, point out problems such as the deplorable state of toilets in Lusaka district markets. Most of the markets in Zambia did not meet the country's requirements for cleanliness, privacy, and the condition and availability of amenities such as toilets and handwashing areas (Meki et al., 2021). A study in Kenya, East Africa, reported that people regarded the water and sanitation services as inadequate. Those present were either inaccessible or poorly maintained. There were also reports that market facilities, such as display stands and platforms, were absent. The allocated space for merchants to conduct their business was unsatisfactory in terms of the available area (Kuboka et al., 2024). Davies et al. (2022) state that

shops that are not well-planned or suitably located can be exposed to competition from other shops, resulting in fewer people wanting to shop there. They also stated that poor infrastructure and a lack of cleaning services can result in health and safety hazards. Moreover, many failures also occur because markets are constrained by infrastructure, equipment, and standards, such as a lack of benefits that promote sustainability, nutrition, or inclusion, high levels of market concentration, and weak value chain integration (Berdegue et al., 2023). Zeynudin et al. (2024) also demonstrated that fruits and vegetables sold in open-air markets in Ethiopia were often contaminated. Wardhana et al. (2021) also found that poor cleaning practices were a factor contributing to Indonesian chicken meat becoming infected with bacteria. Kosoko & Hassan (2021) further noted that some African markets lack sufficient numbers of toilets or clean facilities, which increases the spread of disease. Parkar et al. (2021) also emphasized the importance of maintaining market cleanliness by promoting environmental awareness and proper waste disposal.

From a local perspective, Tomas (2022) further explained that the Omnibus Market Code in Tarlac City implements vendor activities, maintains order and cleanliness, and promotes discipline. The study indeed highlighted the fact that conditions outside the wet Market significantly impact its operations, with most vendors offering a diverse array of goods and services. Carmen et al. (2020) also argued that markets are crucial, as they bring producers into contact with customers, thereby providing small businesses with better opportunities to enter the Market. Similarly, Basadre et al. (2025) found that fish vendors in Panabo Public Market also neglect good hygiene practices, and there are key control points where contamination could occur. Moreover, diseases like cholera, dysentery, typhoid, intestinal worm infections, and polio have been an issue due to poor sanitation. This exacerbates malnutrition adds to the growing problem of antibiotic resistance. In Northern Mindanao, according to Araune et al (2024), compliance with

sanitation regulations at the barangay level remains problematic due to inadequate awareness and weak enforcement. Furthermore, stall owners raise concerns about maintenance and sanitation (Alvarez & Mananap, 2024). Atilano-Tang and Laudin (2023) have also found that the ban on non-biodegradable plastic bags imposed by Zamboanga City has minimized plastic trash and improved the city's cleanliness, despite inadequate law enforcement resources. Similarly, Baptista et al. (2024) found that when authorities clearly implemented rules and sanctions, people in the Cabugao Public Market were more likely to follow regulations on single-use plastics and Styrofoam.

Recognizing that many public markets fail to fully implement existing ordinances, this study evaluates how well vendors, customers, and market officials in the Nasipit Public Market comply with the Revised Market Code, highlighting non-compliance and overall adherence. Anchored in the Local Government Code (LGC) of 1991, which empowers municipalities to regulate market activities, the Revised Market Code of Nasipit (Municipal Ordinance No. 001, Series of 2020) specifies local duties, and assessing compliance delivers evidence-based recommendations for more efficient, safe, and orderly market operations.

This study helps the Municipal Mayor by providing data to identify enforcement gaps, improve administration, and guide policy decision. For the Sangguniang Bayan in strengthening the implementation of the Revised Market Code and improving market operations. For vendors, this study will help them by clarifying their rights and responsibilities and promoting better compliance. For consumers by contributing to a safer and more convenient market experiences. For local market authorities in understanding and fulfilling their enforcement duties. Ultimately, College of Business and Management, it will provide a real-world insights into how regulations and managerial decisions influence market operations and sustainability.

1.2 Review Related Literature

This chapter reviews related studies on the research variables. It discusses the independent variables, including the respondent's demographic profile (respondent's profile according to their role in the market namely; vendors, consumer, and local market authorities) and the dependent variables such as sanitation, security and safety, service area/facilities, occupancy of stalls, rules of conduct, restrictions, prohibition, market fees and charges, electrical charges/fees, general provision and control, and market personnel. It also identifies deficiencies and explains which areas of the provisions are most and least adhered to.

Municipal Ordinance No. 001, Series 2020, or the "Revised Market Code of the Municipality of Nasipit," is a comprehensive law that regulates the entire operation of the Nasipit Public Market. Its main purpose is to ensure that the market is clean, safe, orderly, and properly managed for both vendors and consumers. The ordinance defines key terms, organizes market sections, and sets standards for sanitation, waste disposal, drainage, and public health. It also outlines clear procedures for applying for and occupying market stalls, including requirements, rental fees, limitations, and grounds for cancellation. These rules promote fairness and prevent misuse of market spaces. Additionally, the ordinance lists prohibited acts, such as unauthorized peddling, selling intoxicating drinks, storing hazardous materials, and improper use of stalls, to maintain safety and discipline within the market. The ordinance further provides a detailed schedule of market fees and electrical charges, ensuring transparency in revenue collection that supports market maintenance. It also specifies the duties of the Market Administrator, Treasurer, and other officials responsible for implementing and enforcing the rules.

Vendor

People who sell things at public markets are part of the informal economy, according to Derla and Balongoy (2023). Local, self-employed business owners offer a wide range of goods and services to the community, including meat, vegetables, raw materials, local crafts, and other essential items that people need. However, these providers are crucial for creating jobs and maintaining economic stability, despite often being overlooked. It demonstrates the importance of supporting local companies and providing community members with affordable goods.

According to Lano et al. (2025), every customer's preference in the Calapan City Public Market is quite dependent on the performance of the vendors and overall market service delivery. The responsive service, price equity, and availability of products have brought a high level of customer satisfaction and competitiveness in the marketplace. The research by Atilano-Tang & Laudin (2023) demonstrated that banning single-use plastic, particularly plastic bags, was highly effective due to the considerable compliance of vendors and consumers in bringing their own reusable bags, which ultimately reduced plastic bag usage in practice. Similarly, during on-site surveys, vendors have demonstrated considerable awareness and compliance with regulations, ensuring public health and safety, as well as environmental protection.

However, it is essential to remember that vendors and public markets still face numerous challenges that require assistance and solutions, despite these changes and their significant roles in society. Some sellers reported that customers complained that the other types of packaging did not last as long and cost more than plastic bags. As a result of new rules and the need to make a living for themselves and others, vendors may struggle to cope with such economic and practical issues (Baptista et al., 2024). Additionally, Sarfo et al. (2025) note that some of the challenges hindering the potential of street food vendors include issues with packaging, storage, preparation,

and handling practices, which are often unhygienic and pose a risk to consumers due to low compliance with recommended food safety practices.

Consumer

The customer, also known as a citizen, is one of the most critical individuals in a public market. Not only that, but they also power the market economy. In public markets, people buy and sell goods and services. Customer wants, needs, and buying habits have a significant impact on how the Market works and how long it will last (Lano et al., 2025). According to Alvarez and Mananap (2024), their ability to buy things has a direct effect on how much money sellers make and on the overall economy of the Market. Attracting a large number of people and generating regular sales can help vendors sustain their businesses. In this regard, it helps local companies to grow. Customers who are satisfied with the Market are likely to return and recommend it to others. By doing this, it builds a group of loyal customers that helps the Market maintain its good name and generate revenue (Tumbagahan et al., 2021). Satisfied customers of the Market are likely to return and recommend it to others. In so doing, it develops a loyal customer base that contributes to maintaining a good reputation and generating income for the Market (Tumbagahan et al.,2021). Dudziak et al. (2023) also state that in public markets, the choices regarding the range of products displayed by sellers and the purchasing frequency of consumers are.

In this regard, Tacardon et al. (2023) indicated that consumers in Manila paid close attention to the perceived quality and affordability of street food when choosing what to purchase. It follows that consumers in both the unofficial and official markets demonstrate a preference for quality and are willing to pay more for such high-quality products. What people want influences the types of things or services in the Market. Vendors in the Market modify the

products they sell, including fruits, vegetables, ready-to-eat foods, and handicrafts, to meet the diverse needs and preferences of their clientele (Lano et al., 2025).

However, customers are vital to the success of public markets, and they can also contribute to the aggravation of cleanliness and sanitation problems. Poor waste disposal, a lack of concern for food items, and unhygienic conditions make the conditions unpleasant for both the seller and buyer (Kosoko et al., 2021). According to Wallace et al. (2022), consumers who lack sufficient knowledge about food safety are more likely to purchase unsafe or contaminated goods. The situation not only endangers people's health but also damages the credibility of the public Market, driving customers away from it

Moreover, Buhion et al. (2024) stated that the way people purchase things highly affects the amount of trash produced in the Market. Single-use plastics, excessive packaging, and food waste increase the volume of trash people must handle each day. As Lano et al. (2025) noted, changes may introduce new challenges for vendors. Often, the drive for cheaper, better, and easier-to-use goods forces vendors to change their pricing strategy and the way they stock goods. Similarly, according to Tendero (2023), the people's desire for perfectly shaped fruits and vegetables led them to contribute to food loss, as sellers disposed of foods that were still edible but not aesthetically appealing. This behavior not only incurs financial costs for the seller but also raises environmental concerns. Likewise, Pitriyanti and Kartika (2024) mentioned that traditional markets still have poor cleanliness, with trash piling up and limited areas for cleaning. Additionally, the Conner Public Market faced issues, problems, and concerns, particularly when there were no established rules, insufficient funding, and stands that were too close to each other (Cabilatazan, 2021). According to Ni'am et al. (2024), illegal customer behavior can make the Market less safe and less organized. Haggling excessively, breaking items, or making excessive noise can harm sellers' businesses and negatively impact customers' experiences. The worst

things that can happen are theft and damage, which hurt sellers' profits and make the market community feel unsafe. These actions demonstrate that customers are crucial to the Market's success. However, bad behavior from them can compromise fairness, safety, and the long-term well- being of the entire public market system.

Local Market Authorities/ Market Personnel

The "Revised Market Code" of Nasipit states that there should be a Market Administrator/Supervisor in charge of the public Market. This person should be able to directly oversee all staff working in the area, including those responsible for maintaining the Market's safety, cleanliness, and peace. The Municipal Mayor employs and supervises this person. The Administrator or Supervisor must follow this Code, as well as all applicable laws,

rules, and regulations (Municipal Ordinance No. 001, Series of 2020).

Managing the Market well is an important part of maintaining order, generating more revenue in the neighborhood, and improving service delivery at the city level. The report emphasizes that market leadership often originates from the vendor community, which facilitates mutual understanding among different groups and fosters collaboration and cooperation. Market leaders disseminate important news and messages through various channels, including loudspeakers, leadership committees, notice boards, and digital platforms like WhatsApp. This deep communication style keeps everyone who cares about the Market up to date on what is going on and involved in its operations. They also claim that effective management helps the economy flourish, brings people together, and endures by implementing social programs that educate individuals about essential topics such as sanitation, maintaining market aesthetics, and financial management (Ninsiima et al., 2025). Ni'am et al. (2024) also noted that market personnel play a crucial role in maintaining cleanliness and order. After, they found that having officials present improves people's quality of life by helping maintain cleanliness and order. In terms of public

markets, this study highlights the importance of well-managed local governments from both social and ecological perspectives. From an economic management perspective, adjusting the rental prices of market stalls and kiosks can help keep sellers' costs as low as possible and maintain stable market earnings. These kinds of strategies continue to help local governments strike a balance between economic growth and concerns about inclusivity (Adhayanto & Arianto, 2021).

Tomas (2022) talked about how the local government controls and sets up the Market. His research revealed that market managers establish and enforce rules regarding stalls, facilities, and shared spaces to maintain public markets as fair and well-run. Additionally, he further stated that the government could make the Market more open to non-traditional businesses and franchises in their own areas. Many people will want to start their own businesses as a result, which will make the Market more diverse. On the other hand, the study found wrongdoing at the Tarlac Public Market. One thing is that people sleep in some of the stalls. Besides that, people with stalls who are not supposed to be there often misuse the places that are meant for them. As it also says in the market code, subletting stands is strictly forbidden, but it happens a lot right now. The helpers did not follow the rules and used the same tools in different ways, which shows that there is a lack of control. The Market and its buildings are also not cleaned well enough, and trash is often left inside. On the other hand, rules were clearly made, but they were not always followed because there were not enough workers and supervisors. There are still problems in the way public markets are governed, as stakeholders are not sufficiently involved, communication is inadequate, and participation is insufficient. The communication between leaders and vendors is one-sided and based on authority, whereby leaders give instructions to vendors without providing them with an opportunity for a proper discussion. Moreover, meetings and workshops, which are other avenues of involvement, are rarely utilized, indicating that the usual avenues are ineffective in encouraging people to work together. Vendors, on the other hand, are not receiving much support

in enhancing their skills because most training programs are conducted by external bodies rather than market officials themselves. The growth of vendors is also retarded by limited access to learning materials and a lack of proper training on how to handle and store food to maintain hygiene and cleanliness (Ninsiima et al., 2021).

A Zamboanga-based study identifies, among other things, the limited resources to enforce and monitor compliance as some of the challenges in implementing such policies. Other difficulties it identifies in policy implementation include low resource allocation for policy enforcement and monitoring of compliance (Atilano-Tang & Laudin, 2023). Adding to that, market management was utterly inadequate (Pitriyanti & Kartika, 2024).

Sanitation

Sanitation is an essential part of public health efforts to make environments that support a healthy, wealthy, and happy way of life for people. However, it was also said that the temporary dump places that are available do not meet health standards. Drainage is not good enough. The Market is unhealthy because of these problems, which make shopping less enjoyable for customers and help diseases spread. This means that the Market's basic cleanliness has not been taken care of by the right people (Frebriani et. al, 2025). The World Health Organization (2024) states that everyone needs to think about sanitary issues because they affect everyone's health, the balance of the environment, and everything people do. Poor hygiene can increase your risk of diarrhea, typhoid fever, ascariasis, malnutrition, dysentery, cholera, intestinal worm infections, and other diseases that spread easily. On the other hand, the World Health Organization (2023) release manual showed how to make markets better and healthier by reducing risks and using community-based methods. It tells people how to follow essential rules like "Keep clean" and "Avoid contamination," which will protect public health and safety, make food safer, and stop zoonotic diseases and infectious lung illnesses.

A study by Wardhana et al. (2021) investigated microbial contamination in chicken meat from local markets in Surabaya, Indonesia, revealing significant contamination with Staphylococcus aureus (58.3%) and Salmonella spp. (48.3%), and Escherichia coli (40%). Based on their findings, the researchers attributed these findings to poor sanitation and hygiene practices employed during the slaughtering, handling, and marketing processes. They indicated that improper sanitary conditions in markets can lead to the spread of foodborne pathogens, hence posing serious risks to public health. Their study demonstrated that proper hygiene and sanitation at every stage of the food supply chain are crucial for preventing food contamination and ensuring food safety. Furthermore, Zeynudin et al. in 2024 found that fresh vegetables and fruits sold in open-air markets in Ethiopia were highly contaminated with intestinal parasite ova due to poor sanitation and hygiene practices. The study emphasized that inadequate washing and unhygienic handling contribute to high food contamination, hence connecting the essential dots between sanitation and food safety. However, in developing countries, the growing amount of trash and problems with how to handle it have become a public nightmare. More specifically, people are worried about the unsightliness of trash from different sources in and around the centers of big towns (Akpoghira, 2020).

Also, Umerie et al. (2022) said that self-littering was a usual way of caring for the environment in Nigeria. In most places, trash that has not been separated is taken directly to landfills or open dumping grounds, which is very dangerous for both people and the environment. So, trash needs to be separated, and all biodegradable organic trash needs to be sent to certain landfills and left there for a certain amount of time to break down naturally. Solid garbage management includes making waste, storing it, collecting it, transporting it, sorting it, processing it, and getting rid of it. Scientifically getting rid of trash is very important. Composting, incineration, and landfilling are among the standard procedures for disposing of waste. At the source point,

waste can be segregated into biodegradable and non-biodegradable materials using color coded dustbins, which reduces the quantity that undergoes landfilling (Parkar et al., 2021). Kosoko & Hassan (2021) reported that in the developing world, poor environmental sanitation conditions prevail in markets, often characterized by a lack of adequate toilet facilities. Indeed, Pitriyanti & Kartika (2024) stated that inadequate access to sanitation in the Market can be attributed to many diseases. A considerable percentage of the Market did not fully conform to requirements on community empowerment and clean/healthy living practices. They observed that poor access to sanitation in the Market could cause many diseases.

Meki et al. (2021) also looked at how clean the markets were in the Lusaka District of Zambia. The sites they visited were mainly in terrible shape and did not follow the law when it came to sanitation standards. It was pointed out that places with inadequate sanitation are more likely to have public health problems because of the way the marketing business works, bringing people together and spreading food that can easily get contaminated between sellers and buyers.

Security and Safety

Although public markets are inherently burdened with various challenges, the implementation of different63 measures to improve safety and security has had a positive impact on both stallholders and customers. Revision and implementation of market codes, such as the Omnibus Market Code of Tarlac City in 2020, many improve governance and operative rules that enhance the overall safety and order in the Market (Tomas, 2022). Additionally, many of these regulations include provisions for hygiene and sanitation, which are crucial in preventing health hazards. When met, the market environment becomes safer and more attractive, thereby contributing to the satisfaction of stall owners (Alvarez et al., 2024).

Public administrations can play a role in enhancing open municipal markets by establishing and enforcing safety standards (Fava et al., 2022). Renovation of public markets would advance

economic growth and community development by providing a better, more organized, and safer trading environment, similar to that discussed by Almonte et al. (2024) for the Ibaan Public Market. In enhancing such markets, there is often the provision of better infrastructure, which can encompass improved security. Proper methods for managing trash or other waste help maintain high safety and cleanliness levels, thereby avoiding potential accidents (Sayson et al., 2025).

Despite efforts to enhance security and safety, the majority of public markets, particularly traditional and informal ones, continue to face numerous challenges. Among these, some of the most common include the inadequate sanitary facilities that characterize markets in Lusaka District, Zambia (Meki et. al., 2021). This raises significant concerns regarding hygiene and sanitation, as well as the risk of foodborne illness and other health issues (Dewaal et al., 2025). Putro et al. (2024) stated that such challenges in managing market systems, especially traditional vegetable markets, have led to dissatisfaction among vendors, thereby reducing their livelihoods and investments in their stalls. Moreover, an assessment of water, sanitation, and hygiene conditions in selected markets within Benin City, Nigeria, further shows how the generally neglected environmental aspects create an insecure and unsafe trading environment, negatively affecting the stallholder business operations and likely occasioning losses
(Imarhiagbe & Eghomwanre, 2023).

The inconsistent enforcement of rules, such as curfew hours and deployment of security units, contributes to greater vulnerabilities among the stallholders. Although there are some municipal ordinances, like the Revised Market Code of the Municipality of Nasipit, most of these are weakly or inconsistently implemented and thus offer limited protection against theft and other illicit activities during non-operating hours (Nasipit Municipal Ordinance No. 001, Series 2020). In any discussion of the problems and solutions to traditional market revitalization, better security, infrastructure, and surveillance to prevent such losses are often emphasized; although significant,

such measures are usually lacking, leaving stallholders vulnerable to numerous risks (Davies et al., 2022).

Service Areas / Facilities

According to Dewaal & Trevenen-Jones (2025), storage facilities are essential in maintaining the quality and safety of goods sold in public markets. Moreover, auxiliary facilities include sanitation and waste management systems that provide hygiene and cleanliness within the Market. Researchers in Sub-Saharan Africa have documented that proper storage reduces losses due to spoilage, contamination, and wastage, thereby leading to improved public health and economic sustainability (Aworh, 2021). Similarly, perishable items such as meat and fish require cold storage to remain fresh and safe for consumption (Basadre et al., 2025). In fact, some markets have already invested in refrigeration systems to facilitate vendors in maintaining longer shelf lives and deriving better profitability with reduced food loss. Clean water, functional toilets, and reliable garbage disposal mechanisms ensure that both vendors and customers have a healthy environment in which to work. Access to potable water enables vendors to wash their produce and maintain tidy stalls, thereby reducing the risk of contamination associated with the products they sell. A well-thought- out design of market alleys ensures ease of movement and can even enhance one's market experience (Rosales et al., 2023). Remolino et al. (2023) further mentioned that sufficient space between kiosks prevents crowding in the markets, while neat and dry aisles facilitate safer and more comfortable access for customers. Additionally, proper structuring typically ensures that commodities are well- displayed and easily visible to potential buyers, thereby increasing the chances of sale. Such proper planning increases market appeal, which can lead to improved sales and customer loyalty (Dudziak et al., 2023). However, most markets face numerous difficulties. According to Onuegbu (2024), the Eke Okigwe Market, situated in Nigeria, suffers from inadequate infrastructure, poor storage facilities, and an inefficient collection system.

In addition, Pitriyanti and Kartika (2024) found that the building and sanitation facilities in the Sedanau Island Traditional Market of Indonesia do not meet the required standards. Atilano-Tang and Laudin (2023) also identified some challenges to implementing policies in response to this situation in Zamboanga City. In particular, limited resources for enforcement and compliance monitoring were detected.

Moreover, other infrastructure challenges face the Market in the study of Peri-urban Africa, particularly in low and middle-income countries, which include no permanent access to clean potable water, no toilets, electricity, or cold storage; that space is constrained, there is a lack of facilities for waste disposal and a total lack of investment in waste management; similarly, buildings are not permanent, the facilities for processing are few, and the roads leading to such markets are poor (Wallace et. al., 2022). In Lusaka District, Zambia, markets were found to be in a deplorable state and did not comply with sanitation laws. This study identified deficiencies in facilities such as toilets, handwashing stations, and all other service areas; additionally, these essential facilities lacked cleanliness, privacy, and proper maintenance (Meki et. al., 2021).

Award and Occupancy of Stalls

The Revised Market Code of Nasipit ensures the principle of equity and community participation in the assignment of stalls. According to Section 28, only assigned vendors shall occupy the stalls, which shall be reserved for residents, and then by the class of merchandise carried by the organization. Section 26 then created a Market Committee that shall operate and address the Market's problems. Section 4 prohibits stallholders from occupying stalls or spaces other than their respective leased stalls. Further, Section 28 states that the Awardees of Market Stalls shall pay a One-time "Goodwill Fee" equivalent to Php. $10,000.00 and a deposit of two months' advance rental, which is a burden on the vendors' own poor capitalization. (Municipal Ordinance No. 001, Series 2020).

Alvarez and Mananap (2024) investigated the satisfaction of stall owners regarding public market operations. They found that efficient management of stall occupancy contributed to vendor satisfaction. Similarly, Lano et al. (2025) investigated customer preferences and the level of competitiveness among vendors in public markets in Calapan City, implicitly addressing how stall placement and occupancy affect the success of the businesses and the satisfaction of the vendors. Similarly, Putro et al. (2024) conducted research on the determinants of vendor satisfaction in a traditional vegetable market, which often includes components related to stall assignment and the management system. This finding is consistent with the results of a study conducted in Northern Mindanao, Philippines, which emphasized the importance of strengthening partnerships for marketing and consolidating organic products by providing dedicated market spaces for these products in public markets (Paurom et al., 2025). Similarly, Hasbullah & Wangi (2021) found that there should be a policy or regulation to simplify and expedite the investment procedure. Additionally, Tomas (2022) found in his study that the implementation of market stall awards in Tarlac City involves city officials presenting certificates to the winners after bidding and payment, followed by the signing of contracts and the submission of security deposits to secure possession of stalls. The results of this study show that awarding is highly implemented, with business permit renewals regularly monitored by the market authorities themselves.

In the case of the Lusari Kidul Modern Market in Cirebon Regency, however, it was mentioned that management over market stalls could sometimes be conflictual, particularly in instances where established regulations are lacking or not consistently applied to address the resolution of conflicts of interest in market arrangement, specifically in regulating modern Market stalls (Maulana et. al. 2025). Moreover, a study by Adhayanto and Arianto (2021) on adjusting rental rates for market stalls and kiosks in Pt. The Tanjungpinang Makmur Bersama Market in Indonesia further illustrates the economic considerations associated with stall occupancy, which

have a direct impact on vendors and market sustainability.

Additionally, the abandonment of the Malimgas Public Market project in Dagupan City highlights weaknesses in contractor accountability and the monitoring of public projects. The contractor, after it stopped working, declared bankruptcy and left the vendors with unfinished and unsafe facilities in the middle. This raises questions about the misuse of public funds and calls for tighter monitoring to ensure that contractors fulfill their commitments accordingly (GMA News, 2025).

Rules of Conduct

Pratama & Tukiman (2024) stated that strong discipline, with the full force of the law, was enforced against vendors in Keputran Market, Surabaya, thus reducing illegal vending activities, while emphasizing that local governments should not stop supervising. On the one hand, Ni'am et al. (2024) stressed that adequate supervision and enforcement are crucial to ensure vendors' compliance, as leniency will lead to disorder and unsanitary conditions in public areas.

A case in the Philippines reveals that an ordinance prohibiting the use of Styrofoam and single-use plastics in Cabugao Public Market saw better compliance when there was a proper establishment of rules and penalties. This supports the notion that clear-cut restrictions, coupled with enforcement within the locality, ensure environmental cleanliness and market sustainability (Baptista et al., 2024). Similarly, in Baguio City, prohibitive policies against plastic and Styrofoam usage proved effective only when accompanied by regular monitoring and awareness among vendors (Killip & Dadulla, 2023).

Moreover, Section 5 states that the Public Market shall be maintained at all times in a clean and sanitary condition, as will best protect the health and safety of the buying public, including stall owners, vendors, and Market personnel. Moreover, Section 19 states that the public Market shall be open from 3:00 a.m. to 10:00 p.m., in accordance with safety, order, and sanitation

requirements. This indicates that structured operational hours are in place to maintain order and sanitation. Furthermore, it stated that peddlers shall not be allowed to expose or sell merchandise on sidewalks, courts, or places designated or intended for the passage of the public going to the public Market, indicating that these are potential restrictions on vendors. In addition, Section 43 shall not allow using the Market/Row Stall as living quarters. The penalty shall be the cancellation of the permit. Another section, Section 28, states that no person shall operate a market stall without first securing the license required by this municipality. This section stipulates that a permit is needed to manage a stall in the Market (Nasipit Municipal Ordinance No. 001, Series of 2020).

As such, however, many low- and middle-income cities struggle with the accumulation of solid waste because they lack comprehensive collection and transportation systems, suggesting that poor infrastructure can contribute to waste accumulation. Non-centralized open-air treatment also does not capitalize on the advantages of incineration, a significant limitation that undermines the positive benefits identified in other disposal methods (Wallace et. al, 2024). Poorly managed markets result in dissatisfied vendors. If the vendors perceive the market management as one that does not address their concerns, then they cannot be expected to cooperate with the rules (Putro et al., 2024). Wibisono et al. (2023) also observed that unfair or unclear tax systems result in resentment. Without adequate revenue, according to Onwonga (2024), markets cannot invest in necessary infrastructure, including proper sanitation and waste disposal, which prevents vendors from adhering to hygiene rules.

Market fees & Electrical Charges/Fees

A study in Nairobi City County, Kenya, identified various revenue sources, including taxes, fees, licenses, and user charges, that contribute to the financial sustainability of urban markets in Nairobi County. Analysis revealed diverse revenue types, including direct payments from market traders and indirect contributions from market- related activities such as advertising and rentals.

Market fees are a crucial source of revenue for local governments, enabling them to improve urban service delivery. Furthermore, findings indicated substantial revenue generated from urban markets, underscoring their economic significance and potential for financing91 market operations, infrastructure development, and service provision. It emphasizes the importance of optimizing revenue collection mechanisms, promoting transparency, and allocating resources efficiently to maximize the benefits derived from market-generated revenues (Owonga, 2024). Ninsiima et al. (2025) also mentioned that revenue can be reinvested in market maintenance, infrastructure development, and sanitation services, enhancing the overall market environment.

Furthermore, Adhayanto et al. (2023) highlight that market fees play a key role in boosting local government revenue through profits from regionally owned enterprises. Decentralization and regional autonomy policies have enabled governments to expand their revenue sources via locally generated income (PAD), with one significant source being dividends from regionally owned enterprises (BUMD).

The Revised Market Code of the Municipality of Nasipit outlines specific fees, such as rental fees for stalls, booths, and spaces, to ensure income generation for market operations. Section 44 states that the Municipal Treasurer or authorized collectors shall handle the collection of all local taxes, fees, and charges, showing a structured financial system. In addition, Section 49 provides that stall lessees who consume electricity within the Nasipit Public Market shall pay additional charges to cover utility costs. Section 28 grants preference to resident applicants for stall leases and gives priority to those who pay the goodwill money first, which may result in inequities based on financial capacity. Section 51 imposes a 2 percent surcharge on unpaid bills from the preceding month and authorizes the disconnection of electricity supply if arrearages remain unpaid after two months, ensuring compliance with payment regulations (Nasipit Municipal Ordinance No. 001, Series of 2020).

However, high or unfairly applied market fees can pose a significant financial burden on vendors, particularly small-scale traders. This can reduce their profitability and discourage them from operating in the Market, leading to decreased economic activity. High electrical charges can create a financial strain on vendors, especially those with limited resources (Adhayanto & Arianto, 2021). Additionally, Wibisono et al. (2023) note that the collection of market fees can be susceptible to corruption and mismanagement, diverting funds away from intended improvements.

Restrictions

The Revised Market Code of Nasipit, Article B, provides several provisions to ensure order, cleanliness, and safety within the public market premises. Section 36 states that the act of peddling and hawking on passageways, aisles, sidewalks, or anywhere in the areas intended for the general public is strictly prohibited except in places specifically allowed. It also strictly prohibits the sale of foodstuffs, such as meat or fish, outside the market area before 7:00 p.m. Section 37 maintains that the consumption, serving, and selling of intoxicating beverages inside the market area are strictly prohibited. Any violation will be grounds for a penalty and the revocation of the stall lease. Section 38 provides that no animals should be allowed to roam around the Market; however, any animals caught must be claimed within 24 hours upon payment of 200 pesos. Otherwise, they shall be turned over to the Municipal Agriculture Office. Section 39 provides that no children shall be allowed to loiter and or play within the market premises, and violations by parents shall be subjected to a fine or community service. Section 40 provides that no construction shall be allowed in the Market without the prior approval of the Market Supervisor. On the other hand, Section 41 provides a prohibition that any stallholder who has been ejected for cause from the Market shall not be allowed to apply for another market stall lease (Nasipit Municipal Ordinance No. 001 (Series, 2020).

According to Tomas (2022), peddlers and hawkers are individuals who sell in small quantities and obtain orders by traveling from place to place. As a result, the passageways in the Public Market have been narrowed down, and it shows. Both uptown and downtown market peddlers and hawkers are visible and are increasing in number. This study indicates that the pandemic causes an increase in informal vendors; however, the enforcement of the Tarlac City Omnibus Market Code is inconsistent or "Sometimes Implemented", as some of the respondents mentioned there is no police support given to it. Specifically, the penalties for abandoning stalls and faulty weighing scales, although available, are not consistently enforced, indicating lapses in regulation and enforcement. Also, the study reflected that there is inconsistent implementation regarding intoxicating drinks and weighing scales in public markets, or "Sometimes Implemented", because these problems persist. On the other hand, measures against sidewalk vending and harboring are more consistently implemented, "Often Implemented", which suggests a more concerted effort on the part of the authorities in the specific areas of market concern.

Ghali-Mohammed et al. (2024) added that controlling the informal food sector of LMICs through government- instituted tiered licensing, possibly linked to incentives related to compliance with food safety standards through training and certification programs, was critical. Moreover, local enforcement could be strengthened by empowering community health workers and market associations to monitor and report unsafe food handling practices, thereby promoting food safety and security. This will help sustain the quality of fish and ensure the protection of the public against fish-borne diseases by ensuring that fish is consumed safely.

Prohibition

According to Cataluna & Rukmini (2024), enforcing prohibitions on unhygienic practices among vendors is essential for protecting public health. Their systematic review found that knowledge and practice of hygiene and sanitation remain insufficient among vendors. They

emphasize that regulations banning contamination-prone practices must be coupled with regular inspections, training, and support to ensure compliance. Likewise, studies of plastic-waste prohibition measures indicate that banning certain single-use plastics or restricting their distribution can significantly reduce environmental pollution (Atilano-Tang & Laudin, 2023).

In the Philippines, Baptista et al. (2024) examined the ordinance prohibiting the use of Styrofoam and single- use plastics in Cabugao Public Market. They found that compliance increased when clear rules and penalties were implemented. This supports the idea that well-communicated restrictions and local enforcement help maintain environmental cleanliness and market sustainability. Similarly, in Baguio City, prohibitory policies on plastic and Styrofoam use were effective only when combined with regular monitoring and vendor awareness programs (Killip & Dadulla, 2023).

In contrast, a study by Mensah et al. (2022) found limited public compliance with sanitation and environmental prohibitions in Ghana, despite the existence of such bans. In their findings, regulation falls significantly short of actual practice. One would need appropriate enforcement mechanisms, supported by public education and awareness, to actually attain the desired results of these kinds of prohibitions. Similarly, Araune et al. (2024) observed that sanitation prohibitions were not strictly implemented in a Barangay community in Northern Mindanao. The simple fact that there are rules does not mean that people will necessarily comply with the standards of sanitation. Similarly, the enforcement of an ordinance prohibiting the use of Styrofoam containers and regulating single-use plastics in the Cabugao Public Market revealed that although awareness was high, there were still some setbacks regarding its enforcement and compliance (Baptista et al., 2024). Additionally, Killip et al. (2023) assessed the implementation of a plastic and Styrofoam-free policy in the Baguio City Public Market. They identified several obstacles to effective enforcement, despite the presence of explicit prohibitions.

General Provision and Control

According to Edmonds & Carsjens (2021), well-defined general provisions in the municipal codes are crucial for encouraging order and coherence within a market environment. This study of markets in Michigan cities underscores the importance of clear regulatory frameworks in ensuring the orderly operation and effective management of public markets. This, as identified by Fava et al. (2022), highlights the propitious Role of supportive policies and governance mechanisms that public administrations can implement for open municipal markets. In Kabale and Mbarara Central Markets, efforts were made to explore avenues for stakeholder involvement in the management of public markets in urban centers (Ninsiima et al., 2025).

In contrast to these, traditional Market and rural–urban food system governance in sub-Saharan Africa is especially burdened by weakness in the existing institutional and regulatory frameworks. These weaknesses hamper efficient market functioning and regulation, therefore providing a better understanding of issues related to the management of traditional markets and their impact on local food systems. In a related study, Onwonga (2024) discusses the Role of the county's own- source revenue in the provision and management of markets within Nairobi City County. He underscores the relationship between fiscal sustainability and market governance. Additionally, Tomas (2022) assesses the implementation of the 2020 Omnibus Market Code of Tarlac City, examining the Code's effectiveness in regulating market operations. Although the Code has comprehensive general provisions, there is a mismatch in enforcement; thus, what works in policy does not always work in practice.

1.3 Theoretical Framework

This study will be anchored in the Policy Implementation Theory developed by George C. Edwards III in 1980. The theory provides a foundational framework for analyzing the processes and factors that influence the successful implementation of public policies. Edwards identified that effectiveness in policy implementation is a result of the interaction of four critical variables: communication, resources, the disposition of the implementers, and the bureaucratic structure. These elements shape how policies are interpreted, supported, acted upon, and institutionalized. For this research, the theory of Policy Implementation provides the explanations for the degree of adherence to the Revised Market Code of the Municipality of Nasipit. Communication is how the substance of the market code is clearly and consistently conveyed to stakeholders, including vendors, consumers, and local authorities. Resources are defined to include all economic, human, and material inputs needed to carry out the market code effectively. Disposition refers to the attitudes, motivation, and willingness of implementers, or local market authorities, to implement the policy. Bureaucratic structure refers to the organizational systems, processes, and coordination mechanisms in the municipal government to support and sustain enforcement and monitoring activities (Edwards, 1980).

Support for the applicability of Edwards's theory within this research can be seen from several studies, such as Pratama and Tukiman (2024), who applied Edwards's model when examining the enforcement of regulations for street vendors in Keputran Market, Surabaya. The results demonstrated a furtherance in regulatory understanding and compliance due to good communication between local government leaders and the community. Adequate staffing and support for logistics ensured a smooth implementation, within well-defined standard operating procedures that provided bureaucratic stability. However, variable motivation among implementers led to differences in enforcement levels. The finding showed that disposition is a

crucial variable to be considered for policy impact. By adopting Edwards's Policy Implementation Theory, the present study assesses compliance with the Revised Market Code as an outcome of the effectiveness with which the four interdependent factors operate in the local setting. Where communication is clear, resources are sufficient, implementers are committed, and the bureaucratic structure is functioning well, higher levels of compliance among the market actors are expected. Conversely, defects in any of them may create obstacles to implementation and result in lower levels of compliance. Hence, this theoretical framework not only justifies the research problem but also orients the investigation of the link between policy intentions and actual practices in the context of the Nasipit Public Market.

1.4 Schematic Diagram

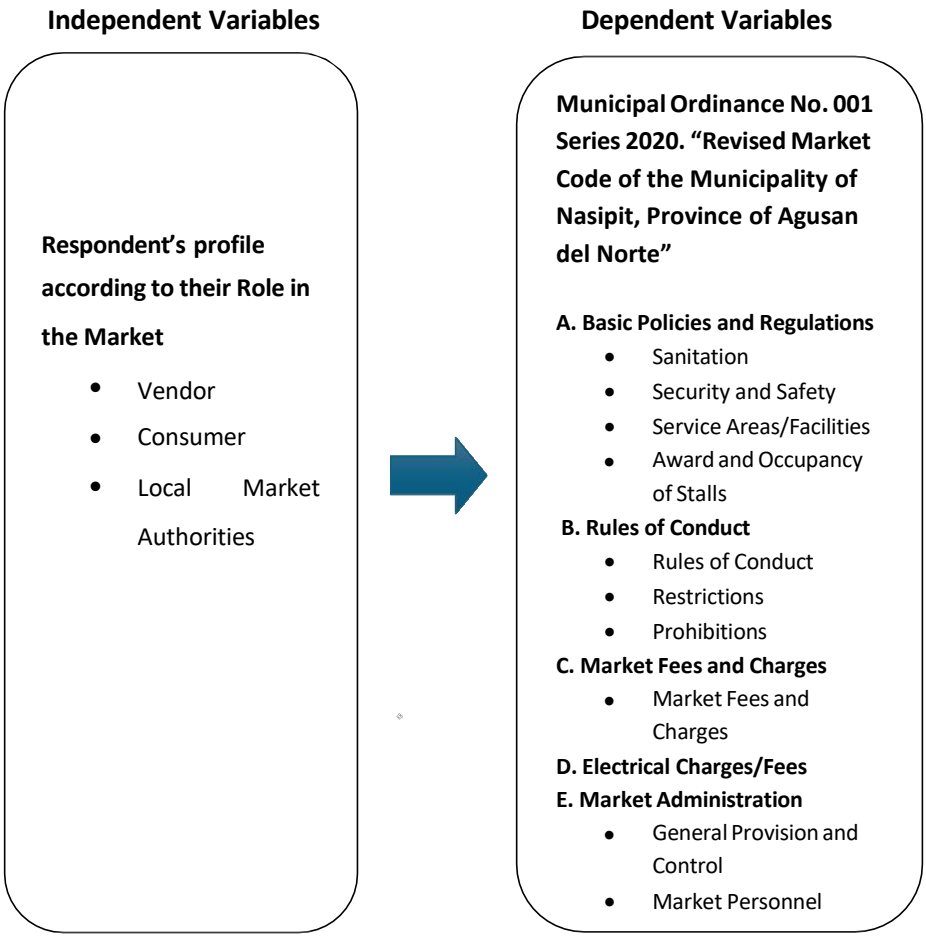


Figure 1. The schematic diagram shows the interplay of the independent and dependent variables of the study.

Statement of the Problem

This study will evaluate compliance to the Revised Market Code of the Municipality of Nasipit. Specifically, this study will answer the following questions:

1. What is the profile of the Respondents according to their Role in the Market:
    1.1 vendors,
    1.2 consumers; and
    1.3 local market authorities.
2. What is the level of compliance to the Revised Market Code of the Municipality of Nasipit according to the general provisions:
    2.1 **Basic Policies and Regulations**
        2.1.1 sanitation,
        2.1.2 security and safety,
        2.1.3 service areas/facilities; and
        2.1.4 award and occupancy of stalls.
    2.2 **Restrictions and Rules of Conduct**
        2.2.1 rules of conduct,
        2.2.2 restrictions, and
        2.2.3 prohibitions.
    2.3 **Market Fees and Charges**
        2.3.1 market fees and charges.
    2.4 **Electrical Charges/Fees**
    2.5 **Market Administration**
        2.5.1 general provision and control; and
        2.5.2 market personnel.

3. Is there a significant difference between the level of compliance to the Revised Market Code of the Municipality of Nasipit when respondents are grouped according to their role in the market: vendors, consumers, and local market authorities?

1.6 Hypothesis

The Hypothesis will guide the study and test at a = 0.05 level of significance.

There is no significant difference between the level of compliance to the Revised Market Code of the Municipality of Nasipit when respondents are grouped according to their Role in the Market : vendors, consumers, and local market authorities.

1.7 Scope and Limitation of the Study

This study focuses on assessing the level of compliance with the Revised Market Code of the Municipality of Nasipit, with particular attention to the general provisions governing basic policies and regulations, restrictions and rules of conduct, market charges/fees, and market administration. The assessment comprises three main groups of respondents, including vendors, consumers, and local market authorities.

The scope of this study focuses on the practical application and adherence to the Revised Market Code within the specific area of public market operations in the Municipality of Nasipit. It will not delve into detailed legal interpretations of the Code itself, nor will it compare Nasipit's market code with those of other municipalities.

1.8 Definition of Terms

To provide clarity, the following terms are defined conceptually and operationally:

Assessment – refers to the systematic process of gathering, analyzing, and interpreting information to determine the level of compliance and effectiveness of implementing the revised market code in the municipality of Nasipit.

Award and Occupancy of Stalls – the process of assigning and regulating the use of market stalls to vendors in the Nasipit Public Market, based on criteria, procedures, and duration outlined in the revised market code.

Compliance – the degree to which market stakeholders, such as vendors, market administrators, and consumers, adhere to the regulations and provisions stated in the revised market code.

Consumers – individuals who visit the Nasipit Public Market to purchase goods and are expected to observe proper conduct and cleanliness within the market premises.

General Provision and Control – the overall rules, authority, and administrative mechanisms established by the municipality to govern, supervise, and regulate operations in the Nasipit Public Market, ensuring adherence to the revised market code.

Market fees – mandatory financial contributions, including stall rents and service fees, collected from vendors in the Nasipit public Market as provided under the revised market code, used for market maintenance and municipal revenue.

Market Personnel – authorized staff and employees responsible for managing, supervising, and maintaining the Nasipit public Market, including security, administrative, and maintenance personnel, as designated in the revised market code.

Municipality of Nasipit – a third-class municipality located in the province of Agusan del Norte, Philippines, which serves as the local government unit (LGU) responsible for the enforcement of the revised market code.

Prohibitions – explicitly forbidden actions, such as unauthorized vending, unsafe practices, or violation of ordinances, within the Nasipit public Market, as mandated by the revised market code.

Revised Market Code – the updated version of the municipal ordinance no. 001 series 2020, which outlines the policies, standards, and procedures for proper market administration and operations within the municipality of Nasipit.

Restrictions – specific limitations imposed on activities, products, or services in the nasipit public Market to ensure compliance with the revised market code, protect public welfare, and maintain market order.

Rules of Conduct – prescribed behaviors and standards expected from vendors, consumers, and local market authorities within the Nasipit public Market, as defined by the revised market code, to maintain order, discipline, and professionalism.

Sanitation – the maintenance of hygienic conditions in the Market, including waste management, drainage, cleaning, and disposal practices, as required under the revised market code.

Security and safety – refers to the implementation of safety protocols, surveillance, and emergency measures within the Nasipit Public Market to protect vendors, consumers, and local Market authorities, in accordance with the revised market code.

Service Areas/Facilities – designated functional spaces within the Nasipit Public Market, including washrooms, storage areas, and loading zones, maintained to provide convenience and support for market operations as stipulated in the revised market code

Vendors – individuals or business operators who occupy stalls or spaces in the Nasipit Public Market to sell goods and are subject to compliance with the provisions of the revised market Code.

CHAPTER 2

METHODOLOGY

2.1 Research Design

This study will employ a quantitative-descriptive approach to examine the compliance level of the Revised Market Code in the Municipality of Nasipit. The quantitative approach is appropriate in this instance because the study will utilize a structured market survey questionnaire designed to capture measurable data on compliance among vendors, consumers, and local market authorities. In contrast, a descriptive design suits the study, given that it aims to examine compliance and describe that compliance without altering any variables

2.2 Research Locale

This study will be conducted in the Municipality of Nasipit, located in the province of Agusan del Norte, Caraga, Mindanao, Philippines. Nasipit is a third-class municipality, known as the gateway to Agusan del Norte, due to its international seaport, the Nasipit Port. Nasipit, Agusan del Norte, was established as a declared pueblo by Spanish colonizers in the 1880s, marking its formal foundation. The municipality's name, "Nasipit," is said to have originated from a misunderstanding about a crab bite, giving it a unique local identity. Officially separating from Butuan on August 1, 1929, Nasipit became a distinct municipality, thereby cementing its place in Agusan del Norte's history, and even resisting a proposed name change to Aurora.

The municipality will be composed of 19 barangays, each contributing to its economic, social, and cultural activities. A central feature of Nasipit's economy will be its public Market, which will serve as the hub of commerce and trade for residents, nearby communities, and travelers.

2.3 Research Respondents

The respondents of this study will consist of vendors, consumers, and local market authorities operating in the Public Market of the Municipality of Nasipit. A purposive and convenience sampling technique will be used to obtain the sample population.

Table 1. Respondents of the Study.

Role in the Market	Population Size	Sample (n)	Percentage (%)
Vendors	192	100	52.3
Consumers	150	61	40.9
Local Market Authorities	25	2	6.8
Total	**367**	**163**	**100**

Table 1 shows the distribution of respondents in the study. A total of (52.3%) samples from a total population of (192) among the vendors in the Nasipit Public Market. A total of (40.9%) from a total population of (150) is derived from the consumers of the Nasipit Public Market. Lastly, a total of (6.8%) from a total population of (25) is derived from the local market authorities of the Nasipit Public Market.

2.4 Research Instruments

This study will utilize a self-made questionnaire anchored in Municipal Ordinance No. 001, Series of 2020, the "Revised Market Code of the Municipality of Nasipit, Province of Agusan del Norte". The instrument will undergo pilot testing and be validated by experts in the field to ensure its reliability and appropriateness for data collection. The survey questionnaire will consist of two (2) parts:

Part I: Respondent Profile. This section will gather information about the respondent's profile according to their Role in the Market.

Part II: Compliance Assessment. This section will assess the respondents' compliance with the Municipal Market No. 001 Series 2020, the "Revised Market Code of the Municipality of Nasipit, Province of Agusan del Norte", consisting of basic policies and regulations, restrictions, rules of conduct, market fees, electrical fees/charges, market administration, and general penal provision.

Table 2. shows the scale description of the survey questionnaire of the study.

Scale	Verbal Description	Interpretation
4	**Always Compliant (AC)**	The respondent consistently follows the provision with no lapses. Compliance is practiced at all times.
3	**Often Compliant (OC)**	The respondent follows the provision most of the time, but with only minor or occasional lapses
2	**Sometimes Compliant (SC)**	The respondent follows the provision occasionally, but overall compliance is low.
1	**Never Compliant (NC)**	The respondent does not follow the provision at all, non-compliance is consistent.

The instrument will use a Likert scale format to measure the degree of agreement with each statement. This table guides the interpretation of Likert scale results in assessing the level of compliance to the revised market code of the municipality of nasipi It will use a 4-point rating scale, where a score of 4 "Always Compliant, a score of 3 "Often Compliant", a score of 2 "Sometimes Compliant", and a score of 1 "Never Compliant". This scale will be used to evaluate the strength of respondents' level of compliance to the revised market code's provision.

2.5 Research Ethical Standard

A. Intellectual Property Rights (IPR)

This research will not involve the development of new technologies, processes, or products that require patent protection. However, the study will include original elements, such as the questionnaires, which will be copyrighted to safeguard the study's distinctive contribution. Furthermore, there will be no distinct brand, logo, or symbol associated with this research. Thus, trademark protection will not be necessary.

B. Informed Consent

All respondents in the study will be provided with an informed consent form that will explain the research objectives, procedures, potential risks, and benefits. Each respondent will confirm voluntary participation and complete understanding of the study by signing the form. No animals will be involved in this research; therefore, additional ethical approval for animal testing will not be required. This process will ensure the protection of respondents' rights and understanding.

C. Data Privacy and Confidentiality

The researchers will maintain and protect the confidentiality of the respondents in this study, in accordance with data privacy regulations, to ensure that no personal or sensitive information is compromised. All data provided will be safeguarded, ensuring that the research findings will not be linked and will be directly attributed to specific respondents. All the gathered data will be secured and confidential. Appropriately, the researchers assure that privacy protection will protect the confidentiality of study respondents and the specific participating institutions.

D. Voluntary Participation

In this study, the respondents will be volunteers. The selected vendors, consumers, and local market authorities will not be obligated to continue the survey if the respondents believe it causes emotional or physical harm. The voluntary approach will provide a sense of autonomy and empower respondents to dedicate their time and effort to participating in the study.

E. Minimization of Harm

The researchers will design the study to minimize potential harm to all the respondents by carefully selecting and making the survey questionnaires safe, and avoiding physical, psychological, or emotional harm. Respondents will be informed about the purpose, processes, possible risks, and rights. Support services will be provided in the event of damage or discomfort, including emergency hotlines, professional counseling sessions, and immediate assistance. No animals will be involved; therefore, no additional protections or ethical standards for animals are required. This approach will enhance the respondent's well-being and uphold moral standards throughout the entire study process.

F. Beneficence

The research purpose is to positively impact the local government by providing insights into the level of compliance with the Revised Market Code of the Municipality of Nasipit. The findings will help the Local Market Authorities of Nasipit identify areas for improvement in policy enforcement and market management. After all the research findings are completed, all rndents will be given access upon request.

G. Justice and Fair Respondents Selection

The researchers will select respondents fairly and transparently, ensuring that market **vendors, consumers, and local authorities** from different backgrounds and sectors are equally represented. This will promote fairness and inclusivity, ensuring that all relevant groups are represented in assessing compliance with the Revised Market Code of the Municipality of Nasipit.

H. Data Integrity and Accuracy

The researchers will use clear and organized methods to ensure accurate and consistent data collection and analysis. To maintain objectivity, access to the data will be limited to the researchers. The researchers will also consider potential biases and limitations that could affect the results, such as sampling issues or unclear responses. When some respondents leave parts of the survey unanswered, the researchers will respectfully follow up and ask to complete the missing items to ensure the data is valid and complete. To address these concerns, specialists will authenticate the survey, incomplete forms will be adequately managed, and all findings will be provided honestly.

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K. Transparency in Reporting

The results of this study will be disclosed with utmost honesty and transparency, guaranteeing that the collected data will not be excluded, misconstrued, or modified. All contents that have been published before and are still under copyright will be appropriately cited and credited. AI tools will be utilized to enhance and refine information relevant to specific aspects of

the ongoing research. The researchers will declare that the study is free from any financial, personal, or professional conflicts of interest.

L. Use of Patented or Copyrighted Materials

The study will not utilize any patented materials; therefore, no approval from patent owners is required. The researchers will cite all copyrighted materials, including relevant literature, and obtain necessary permissions.

M. Ethical Considerations for Animal and Human Trials

Ethical considerations in research necessitate a thorough understanding of the study's potential effects, benefits, and risks. The researchers will inform respondents that this study poses no physical risks, as it focuses solely on their responses and does not involve any physical activities. However, the researchers will provide proper support services if necessary. Since no animals will be involved, ethical clearance for animal use will not be required. The focus will be solely on human respondents, with sufficient ethical frameworks and procedures to ensure their safety and obtain informed consent.

N. Responsible Use of AI and Related Technologies

The researchers will utilize AI tools such as Grammarly and Quillbot to enhance the study's grammar and clarity. ChatGPT will also assist with the writing process and help you select the most suitable words. These tools will only be used to assist the researchers, not to replace their own thoughts and decisions. The researchers will carefully review and evaluate all the ideas, analyses, and findings. They will ensure that the study remains accurate, trustworthy, and ethical by employing AI appropriately and verifying all its outputs.

O. Ethical Approval

This research will receive ethical approval from the Research Ethics Committee (REC) and the Research and Instructional Innovation Department (RIID) of Saint Michael College of Caraga, which confirms that it adheres to all relevant guidelines on the protection of respondents, data privacy, and intellectual property rights.

Data Gathering Procedure

With the Mayor's approval, the researchers will request permission from the Office of the Mayor of Nasipit to obtain the number of vendors and local market authorities at the Nasipit Public Market. Researchers will distribute survey forms after obtaining respondents' consent and will allow sufficient time for them to complete the forms. After completing the questionnaires, the researchers will collect and examine them, then calculate the mean of the results to summarize the findings on conformity with the Revised Market Code.

Letter of Approval: The researchers will submit a letter of request to the Office of the Mayor of Nasipit to validate the study and obtain permission to proceed with assessing compliance with the revised market code. Orientation: The researchers will conduct an orientation for the respondents to inform them about the study and ensure they understand the ethical agreements related to assessing compliance with the revised market code.

Distribution of Informed Consent Forms: The researchers will distribute informed consent forms to the respondents, which will serve as agreements confirming that they understand their rights and have the freedom to agree or decline to participate in the study, in compliance with the revised market code.

Distribution of Questionnaire: The researchers will personally distribute the survey questionnaires to the respondents. The researchers will give respondents ample time to provide the information required for the study on compliance with the revised market code.

Retrieval of the Questionnaire and Consent Form: After the allotted time, the researchers will personally retrieve the completed questionnaires and consent forms to prepare for data collection related to assessing compliance with the revised market code. Gathering of Data: The data will be collected, checked for completeness, tallied, presented, analyzed, and interpreted using appropriate statistical techniques and tools to assess the level of compliance with the revised market code.

Statistical Treatment

The following statistical techniques and methods were employed to facilitate the presentation, analysis, and interpretation of the findings.

The researchers will use **frequency and percentage** to determine the distribution and rate of the total number of respondents."

Researchers will use the **weighted mean** to assess the level of compliance with the Revised Market Code of the Municipality of Nasipit.

The **One-Way ANOVA** will be used to determine the significant difference in the level of compliance with the Revised Market Code of the Municipality of Nasipit among respondents grouped by their Role in the Market: vendors, consumers, and local market authorities.

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